

Tuesday, 1 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON Overcast 22° 15°	BIRMINGHAM Light drizzle 20° 13°	MANCHESTER Overcast 20° 13°	GLASGOW Rain 16° 14°
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01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1

The government's early release scheme for prisoners is causing concern, with Conservatives warning it could see dangerous criminals freed.

This follows the Prime Minister's suggestion that some prisoners serving indefinite sentences might be released to ease prison overcrowding. It's a significant story dominating the papers today.

POLITICS · UK
- 2

Parents of seriously ill children should be given paid leave to care for them, according to the Children's Commissioner.

Dame Rachel de Souza is backing calls for more support for parents and carers at a time when they need it most. It's an issue that affects so many families across the country.

SOCIAL AFFAIRS · UK
- 3

The UK has raised the case of a British student activist, Finn Joughin, who was detained by settlers in the West Bank.

The 22-year-old was arrested in the Palestinian village of Umm Al-Kheir. His situation is being closely monitored by the UK government.

INTERNATIONAL · UK
- 4

An investigation is underway after a delivery driver was killed in a train crash at a 'high risk' crossing.

The incident has raised fears about the safety of such crossings. Authorities are working to determine the exact cause of the tragedy.

ACCIDENT · UK
- 5

An 85-year-old grandfather has sadly died months after confronting burglars at his home.

Gordon Nicholass was the victim of a burglary in Lancashire. Police are investigating the circumstances surrounding his death.

CRIME · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Scottish soap opera River City is set for a fiery finale, with hints of an explosive end to its 24-year run.**
 The much-loved show, set in the fictional Glasgow district of Shieldinch, is finally coming to an end. Fans are eagerly anticipating how the story will conclude after all these years.
ON AIR – Are you a River City fan? How do you think it should end?
 TV · COMING UP
- 2 An actor who was told he had Alzheimer's is now taking on a challenging one-man show on the London stage.**
 Peter Marinker is performing one of Samuel Beckett's most famous plays alone. It's an incredible story of resilience and passion for performance.
ON AIR – What an inspiring story! Have you ever had to overcome a big challenge to pursue something you love?
 THEATRE · COMING UP
- 3 Paul Heaton has scored his first number one album, while Dolly Parton's classic '9 to 5' finally makes the UK Top 40!**
 Heaton's solo album has topped the charts, a fantastic achievement. And after all these years, Dolly's iconic track has finally reached the UK Top 40, proving its enduring popularity.
ON AIR – What's a classic song you love that you're surprised didn't hit the Top 40 sooner?
 MUSIC · THIS WEEK
- 4 Charli XCX brought an electrifying, era-spanning set to Reading Festival, headlining the first night.**
 The British singer captivated the crowds, alongside Irish rock band Fontaines DC. It sounds like it was an unforgettable start to the festival weekend!
ON AIR – Did you catch Charli XCX at Reading, or any other acts? What was your highlight?
 MUSIC · THIS WEEK
- 5 Lola Young made a surprise appearance at Reading Festival, performing a set on the final day.**
 The singer has been gradually returning to performing after taking a break last year. It was a welcome return for her fans at the festival.
ON AIR – It's great to see artists take time for themselves. Who are you hoping to see back on stage soon?
 MUSIC · THIS WEEK

On the schedule

1 **Manchester City are reportedly in talks with Chelsea to sign Enzo Fernandez, as transfer deadline day approaches.**

This is one of the big stories in the football world as clubs scramble to complete deals. Arsenal are also exploring a move for Malick Fofana.

ON AIR – Who do you think needs to make the biggest signing before the transfer window closes?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **Football fans are eagerly watching for standout transfers as the window prepares to slam shut.**

BBC Sport's experts are highlighting the deals most likely to go through before Tuesday's 11 PM BST deadline. It's always a frantic time for clubs!

ON AIR – Which transfer rumour are you most excited to see come true, or fall apart?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **British qualifier Harriet Dart has ended a 19-month wait for a Grand Slam singles win at the US Open.**

She fought back to beat Peyton Stearns in the first round, a fantastic achievement. It's a brilliant start for Dart at her 'home away from home'.

ON AIR – What a comeback! Is there anything more satisfying than seeing a British player win at a major tournament?

TENNIS · UK

4 **England have humbled Pakistan at Lord's, confirming a dominant series win with one match still to play.**

They bowled Pakistan out for 194 in their second innings, securing a 194-run victory on day four of the second Test. It's been a brilliant performance from the England side.

ON AIR – What's been the secret to England's success in this series against Pakistan?

CRICKET · UK

5 **Chelsea maintained their perfect start to the season under Xabi Alonso, winning a thrilling seven-goal encounter against Brighton.**

They held off a Brighton fightback to win 4-3 at Stamford Bridge. It sounds like a fantastic game for the neutral!

ON AIR – Do you think Chelsea can keep up this perfect start and challenge for the title this season?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A recent trend sees more people embracing the gentle art of 'leaf pressing' to preserve the beauty of autumn.**
It's a lovely way to connect with nature and create unique decorative pieces for the home. Think of all those gorgeous colours!
- 2 Research suggests that 'reading aloud' to oneself, even silently, can improve comprehension and memory.**
So next time you're trying to grasp something tricky, a little internal monologue might just be the answer!
- 3 The simple pleasure of 'baking your own bread' from scratch is experiencing a significant rise in popularity.**
There's nothing quite like the smell of a fresh loaf filling the kitchen, is there? And it's so rewarding!
- 4 More individuals are discovering the calming effects of 'birdwatching' from their own gardens.**
It's a fantastic, low-cost hobby that brings a little bit of the wild right to your doorstep. Binoculars at the ready!
- 5 A growing number of people are taking up 'knitting or crochet' as a mindful and creative pastime.**
The rhythmic motion is wonderfully relaxing, and you end up with something cosy and handmade. Perfect for cooler evenings.
- 6 The delightful tradition of 'writing and sending postcards' while on holiday is making a comeback.**
There's something so personal about receiving a handwritten message from afar, much more special than an email!
- 7 Studies indicate that spending time in a 'forest or woodland' can significantly reduce stress levels.**
It's often called 'forest bathing' and it's all about immersing yourself in the calming atmosphere of nature. We could all use a bit of that!

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of biscuits will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: SMELLING THE PACKET BEFORE OPENING IT!

Q Our survey said that over 55% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot bowl of soup, especially if it's a new recipe. What is it?

ANSWER: ARRANGING ALL THE INGREDIENTS IN A SPECIFIC ORDER ON THE SPOON BEFORE THE FIRST BITE!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a 'particular colour' can just make you feel instantly happy or calm?**
What's that one colour that always seems to lift your spirits, and why do you think it has such an effect on you?

- **We all have those 'little everyday sounds' that just make us feel instantly at home or bring a smile to our face, don't we?**
What's one of those comforting household noises that you wouldn't trade for anything, and what memory does it bring back?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** The footprints left by astronauts on the Moon could remain there for millions of years because there's no wind or water to erode them.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** Astronauts once accidentally left a small, fully grown oak tree on the Moon during an Apollo mission, which surprisingly survived in the vacuum.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£5.2 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£5.2 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually helped to eradicate the Great Plague by burning down rat-infested areas.
- A group of owls is called a 'parliament', which sounds rather distinguished.
- The world's oldest known piece of chewing gum is 9,000 years old and was discovered in Finland.
- Butterflies taste with their feet, which helps them to find suitable plants to lay their eggs on.
- The 'smiley face' emoticon was invented in 1982 by computer scientist Scott Fahlman.
- The human nose can remember 50,000 different scents, a truly impressive feat.
- There are more chickens in the world than there are people, by quite a margin!
- The 'penny-farthing' bicycle got its name from the size difference between its two wheels, resembling the two coins.

On this day

Day 244 of the year, 121 days left in 2026. Today Feast of Creation (Christianity); Christian feast day: Constantius (Costanzo) of Aquino; Christian feast day: David Pendleton Oakerhater (Anglican Communion); Christian feast day: Giles. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1976 — Clare Connor, English cricketer
- 1990 — Aisling Loftus, English actress
- 1928 — George Maharis, American actor, singer, and artist (died 2023)
- 1961 — Boney James, American saxophonist, composer and producer
- 1984 — Joe Trohman, American singer-songwriter, guitarist and producer
- 1944 — Leonard Slatkin, American conductor and composer
- 1963 — Grant-Lee Phillips, American musician and actor
- 1948 — Greg Errico, American drummer and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1873 — Cetshwayo ascends to the throne as king of the Zulu nation following the death of his father Mpande.
- 1894 — Over 400 people die in the Great Hinckley Fire, a forest fire in Hinckley, Minnesota.
- 1862 — American Civil War: Confederate forces under General Stonewall Jackson inflict heavy casualties in the Battle of Chantilly during the Union withdrawal from the Northern Virginia campaign.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1838 — Saint Andrew's Scots School, the oldest school of British origin in South America, is established.
- 2008 — Iraq War: The United States Armed Forces transfers control of Anbar Province to the Iraqi Armed Forces.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1969 — A coup in Libya brings Muammar Gaddafi to power.
- 1836 — Narcissa Whitman, one of the first English-speaking white women to settle west of the Rocky Mountains, arrives at Walla Walla, Washington.

- 1873 — Cetshwayo ascends to the throne as king of the Zulu nation following the death of his father Mpande.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 245 of the year, 120 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Acepshimas of Hnaita and companions (Syriac Orthodox Church); Christian feast day: Agricola of Avignon; Christian feast day: Antoninus of Pamiers; Christian feast day: Brocard. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1979 — Jonathan Kite, American actor and comedian
- 1975 — Jill Janus, American singer (died 2018)
- 1967 — Frank Fontseré, American drummer and songwriter
- 1929 — Victor Spinetti, Welsh actor and director (died 2012)
- 1981 — Chris Tremlett, English cricketer
- 1968 — Cynthia Watros, American actress
- 1966 — Salma Hayek, Mexican-American actress, director, and producer
- 1934 — Sam Gooden, American soul singer (died 2022)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1998 — Swissair Flight 111 crashes near Peggy's Cove, Nova Scotia; all 229 people on board are killed.
- 2024 — A suicide bombing in Kabul, Afghanistan, kills 6 people and injures 13.
- 1985 — Sri Lankan Civil War: Sri Lankan Tamil politicians and former MPs M. Alalasundaram and V. Dharmalingam are shot dead.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1984 — Seven people are shot and killed and 12 wounded in the Milperra massacre, a shootout between the rival motorcycle gangs Bandidos and Comancheros in Sydney, Australia.
- 1968 — Operation OAU begins during the Nigerian Civil War.

10 — FORWARD PLANNING • FILM

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 4	Conjuring: Last Rites
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FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
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FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
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FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
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OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW

FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
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FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)
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11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar